

(The moral of the story is that your kids take things in, and they're very literal.) Proceed with caution. You might not want to blend the card: instead you could cut it up, and stick it to the fridge door as a trophy and reminder that in your family you don't do credit cards.

What if I'm really struggling with my credit card debt and I don't want to worry my kids?

I totally get why you wouldn't want to show your kids, and of course it's up to you. However, what I will say is that there is incredible power in vulnerability. Okay, so that sounds like something Oprah would say, but stick with me here.

What I mean is that you're being honest with your kids; you're not trying to sugarcoat your situation and act all 'do as I say, not as I do'. Instead you're saying: 'I've messed up but I have the power to change things, and I will . . . starting right now as I blend these buggers!'

But doesn't my kid need to build up their credit so they can get a home loan at some stage?

No. A credit card won't help you get a home loan, any more than a flash pair of runners will help you win a marathon. What matters is a history of savings, no personal debts and a decent-paying job.

What about personal loans, are they any different from a credit card?

They're the Khloé Kardashian of debt: they don't get as much publicity as their sister, but they're just as dumb.

How am I supposed to buy things online without a credit card?

Get a debit card—they do basically the same thing, but with your money.